C.E, 2016). This gives furthermore empirical evidence for the Out of India Migration Theory.

As far as the origin of this deity is concerned a few scholars also have *Zurvan hypothesis* according to which this deity *Zun* relates to the Sassanid Zoroastrian deity Zurvān, the deity of time.

Gulman S writes as below in his paper (Etymology of Zhunbil and Identity of the Rulers of Kabul and Zabul in Seventh -Ninth Centuries C.E, 2016):

> *Regarding origin of Žuna, Xuanzang had only mentioned that it was initially brought to Kapisa, later Begram from "far" and later moved to Zabul. There is no consensus as to who brought it and when. By identifying Žun with Sassanian Zurvān, the cult of Žun or *Zruvān can be viewed in a much wider context of Iranian history and religious developments. Žun, Like Zurvān, most likely represented the "god of time", a heresy in Zoroastrianism, which originated in response to the religious reforms introduced during second half of Achaemenid Empire. The cosmopolitan nature of the god is consistent with the variety of religions practiced in the region prior to the Islamization of Afghanistan.*

He holds a thesis that the Afghan followers of *Zun* were initially Zoroastrians in all probability. Mention of Zun and its devotees began to vanish with the end of Zunbil dynasty of Zabulistan in AD 870. According to Ibn Athir the followers of *Zun* accepted Islam in later phase (Etymology of Zhunbil and Identity of the Rulers of Kabul and Zabul in Seventh -Ninth Centuries C.E, 2016).

Scholar Ulf Jager states in his paper that, 'we should interpret "*Zhun*" as the name of the ancient Iranian deity of time, "Zurwan."' (A Unique Alxon-Hunnic Horse-and-Rider Statuette, (Late Fifth Century C E) from Ancient Bactria / Modern Afghanistan in the Pritzker Family Collection, Chicago, 2019)